

Aleksandr Smirnov

asmirnov3@wisc.edu, (224)803-5233, [GitHub Profile](#)

SUMMARY

M.S. student in Electrical and Computer Engineering at UW–Madison with demonstrated knowledge of semiconductor process integration and device physics from two years of industry experience and graduate coursework. Coordinated activities across process development, design, and test engineering teams at Polar Semiconductor to support development targets and technology transfer timelines for a GaN-on-Si power transistor family. Have a track record of applying Design of Experiments (DOE) and statistical modeling to drive process development in multi-functional engineering environments. Leveraged AI and AI-assisted tools to enhance technical research, data interpretation, and engineering decision-making across metrology and testing workflows.

EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Master of Science in Electrical and Computer Engineering, Expected December 2027

- Cumulative GPA 3.81/4.0

Moscow Engineering Physics Institute

Bachelor of Science in Engineering Physics, January 2022

- Awarded Presidential Scholarship for Academic Excellence

Relevant Coursework: Advanced Digital VLSI Circuit Design, Semiconductor Device Physics, Solid State Electronics, Integrated Circuit Design

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Polar Semiconductor, Bloomington, MN

Process Integration Engineering Intern, May 2026 – August 2026

- Achieved development targets ahead of aggressive timelines for the Renesas 650 V GaN-on-Si power transistor technology transfer from a 6-inch reference production line to Polar's 8-inch fab, coordinating execution across process development, design, and test engineering.
- Used Design of Experiments and statistical analysis to reach the best contact resistance and uniformity among the fabs on the transfer agreement; developed alternative process flows for single-tool steps and designed splits where the reference process was incompatible with the existing tools.
- Built AI-assisted tools that merges metrology and testing data per die site, gates bad data, and outputs wafer maps with edge/center statistics – streamlining engineering decision-making and data analysis, and reducing process iteration time.

Contributed to TCAD model calibration by building the Process workbench, and characterized I-V, C-V, terminal capacitance, leakage, and breakdown behavior on the Minesweeper lot and subsequent lots.

Eurofins EAG Laboratories, San Jose, CA

Analyst, January 2023 – January 2025

- Supported major semiconductor equipment vendors in developing and qualifying etch & deposition processes for critical client demonstrations by performing advanced TEM/SEM analysis, defect identification, and metrology; results directly enabled process optimization and successful technology showcases.
- Executed failure analysis and materials characterization for TSMC, Apple, META Reality Labs, and Tesla on semiconductor devices, AR/VR photonics components, and EV battery systems; identified root-cause defects for client product validation teams, accelerating time-to-market for next-gen hardware.
- Prepared technical reports, developed standard operating procedures, and mentored junior team members to improve lab workflows.

State Corporation 'Rosatom', Moscow, Russia

Design Engineer, January 2022 – September 2022

- Proposed design changes to electronic devices based on experimental data, enhancing reliability and performance.
- Enhanced performance of X-ray tubes, neutron emitters, and other electronic devices through physical modeling and simulation.
- Optimized output characteristics and reliability of electronic devices via Design of Experiments (DOE) and Statistical Process Control (SPC).

Engineering Intern, January 2021 – January 2022

- Conducted SEM and SIMS analyses in support for R&D activities.
- Investigated defective products and identified root causes of failure.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Custom 6T SRAM Cell Design: Designed a six-transistor SRAM cell at the transistor level in Cadence Virtuoso with the 28 nm GlobalFoundries PDK for a 0.7 V supply. Sized the pull-down, access, and pull-up transistors from the cell ratio and the pull-up ratio to hold the read SNM above 130 mV and the write SNM above 270 mV, both extracted from DC butterfly curves. Simulated the read and write operations with 25 ps input edges and 10 fF bit-line loads. Verified a non-destructive read and a correct write from the WL, Q, QB, BL, and BLB waveforms.

2D FDFD Waveguide Coupling Solver and Optimization Study: Created a 2D finite-difference frequency-domain (FDFD) solver in Python for simulation of coupling into a 220 nm SOI slab waveguide at 1550 nm. Developed solver showed physically meaningful results making possible optimization studies with output comparable to real coupler designs. The coupling efficiency and insertion loss was calculated from a Poynting-vector power probe at the input and a modal decomposition at the output. The solver used a five-point sparse Helmholtz operator with perfectly matched layers, vectorized matrix assembly, and a direct sparse LU factorization.

Ab-initio Calculations of GaN Transport Properties: Calculated the phonon-limited electron and hole mobility of bulk wurtzite GaN from first principles with Quantum ESPRESSO and EPW. Completed the full chain: variable-cell relaxation, SCF and NSCF calculations, DFPT phonons, Wannier interpolation, and a Boltzmann transport solution. Compared the lattice constants, band structure, and phonon dispersion with published values at each stage before the transport step.

Planetary MOCVD Reactor Design for AlGaInAs Laser-Diode Epitaxy: Designed a planetary MOCVD reactor concept for AlGaInAs laser-diode epitaxy on 4-inch InP wafers. Selected source and carrier gases' parameters from published data on parasitic reactions, Al and In surface kinetics, and carbon incorporation. Wrote a Python model from bubbler vapor pressures to boundary-layer growth rate, with area-weighted uniformity for wafers with and without rotation. Showed viability of the design by testing against laminar-flow, natural-convection, and entrance-length criteria.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Fields of Expertise

TCAD modeling, Computer Aided Design (CAD), material analysis and characterization, Design of Experiments (DOE), Statistical Process Control (SPC)

Software

JMP, Cadence Virtuoso, HSpice, Synopsis Sentaurus TCAD, Silvaco Atlas TCAD, COMSOL

Programming Languages

Python, C, SQL

Certificates

'Design of Experiments Specialization' - Arizona State University